

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 810

By Powell

A RESOLUTION to honor and commend the Wright Middle School Mariachi Ensemble and Director Maikel Rodriguez.

WHEREAS, it is fitting that the members of this General Assembly should recognize and celebrate those exceptional individuals and organizations whose contributions enrich the cultural fabric of our State and uplift the lives of our citizens, especially our youth; and

WHEREAS, the Wright Middle School Mariachi Ensemble, under the leadership of Director Maikel Rodriguez, has achieved statewide and national recognition for its outstanding musicianship, perseverance, and cultural pride; and

WHEREAS, in October 2025, this talented group of student musicians had the distinct honor of serving as the opening act for Grammy Award–winning artist Jason Isbell at the Ryman Auditorium, a revered venue often referred to as the "Mother Church of Country Music"; and

WHEREAS, this remarkable opportunity represented not only a milestone for the students and the Wright Middle School community but also a testament to the power of music education and the enduring strength of cultural heritage; and

WHEREAS, the mariachi ensemble reflects the rich diversity of Metro Nashville Public Schools, welcoming students from across the globe, including Honduras, Morocco, and Cuba, and offering them a space to express pride in their identities and traditions through the art of mariachi; and

WHEREAS, Director Maikel Rodriguez, himself a Cuban immigrant whose path to music education was forged through resilience and dedication, has revived and transformed Wright Middle School's mariachi program through tireless mentorship, inclusivity, and high standards of excellence; and

WHEREAS, through Mr. Rodriguez's leadership, the students have performed at notable venues such as Nissan Stadium, the Country Music Hall of Fame, and Plaza Mariachi and have brought the spirit of mariachi to local elementary schools across the city, inspiring the next generation; and

WHEREAS, the group's performance at the Ryman not only provided a prestigious platform but also earned the ensemble a \$5,000 donation, which will help fund official uniforms and necessary equipment, further strengthening the program's long-term sustainability; and

WHEREAS, the ensemble's success is rooted in values that transcend the stage: pride in one's roots, camaraderie, and a shared commitment to community and artistic growth; and

WHEREAS, on this noteworthy occasion, it is most fitting that we honor the hard work and talent of the Wright Middle School Mariachi Ensemble and Director Maikel Rodriguez; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor and commend the Wright Middle School Mariachi Ensemble and Director Maikel Rodriguez for their inspiring performance as the opening act for Jason Isbell at the Ryman Auditorium, applaud their outstanding season of performances, and extend to them our best wishes for much continued success.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.